

ITUNES

While Apple makes great devices that have garnered dedicated fandom, the same can't be said about the accompanying software. Or can it? With the last few iterations of iTunes, Apple has been accused of fixing what wasn't broken in their efforts to 'beautify' and 'simplify'. Love it or hate it, in true geek spirit we show you how to make the best of what you have!

Un-vanish the Sidebar

The new multi-color logo looks jazzy but certain other aspects of the redesign are a pain, especially the absence of the Sidebar from the main screen. Although it's not gone altogether, the Sidebar only shows up under the Playlists tab. If you consider that a pain, feel free to write a mail to Apple. Enough feedback showing dissent and they may actually start to listen!

Mini Switch to Mini Player

The latest redesign makes the Mini Player handier than ever, but if you're confused about how to access it other than labouriously going through the menu, fret not! Simply click on the Album artwork, next to 'Now Playing' at the top of the screen. The Mini Player appears that floats above your windows (make sure to check the box next to iTunes > Preferences > Advanced > "Keep Mini-Player on top of all other windows") for easy control over what befalls your ears while you work. Note: If you want the Mini Player above the iTunes window itself, go to the Menu bar > Window > MiniPlayer.

Switch to a Micro Mini Player (Muzzy)

If the Mini Player does not seem minimalist enough to you, download a great (and still free)



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Tips & Tricks has its own page numbers, and does not follow the rest of the magazine's page numbers. This is done to ensure that you can cut out and save T&T in a separate folder for later reference.



Muzzy - Minimalism in action

iTunes plugin called Muzzy. It runs from the menu bar and allows easy and intuitive control over song playback, especially



Muzzy - The Micro Player

great if you need to use the whole screen and don't want to keep switching to iTunes. Adjusting the position of playback within the currently playing song is as simple as clicking/dragging across the album artwork drop-down. It will even pause playback when your headphones are plugged out!

Capture the heat of the moment - In a playlist

Want to listen to a song that just came to your mind, but



Add lyrics to your favourite songs

you like what's playing now, and so you don't know what to do? Right -click any song and select "Add to Up Next", a temporary On-the-Go playlist that gets modified as easily as your mood.

Save space: Turn on Home Sharing!

If you have multiple devices running iTunes on the same WiFi network, you can use this nifty feature to access a common library across all devices. From the Menu bar select File > Home Sharing > Turn on Home Sharing. Do this and log in with the same Apple ID on all the different devices. You can save as much space as the number of copies of your Library!

Apple Music - Buy into the hype at no cost!

In case you didn't already notice, Apple Music is promoting itself with a 3-month FREE trial membership. Though, you will need a credit card enabled Apple account to access it. Click on the tab that reads "For You" on the top centre of the iTunes window and follow the instructions to activate your free trial. Don't forget to deactivate before your trial is over to avoid being charged!